

Is the **Internet of Things** the Future for **Smart India**



The Internet of Things (IoT) has the potential to bring the next industrial revolution, transform society and establish a new ecosystem to serve not just humans but humanity. In an IoT-enabled world, people will receive uniquely personalised services on demand, while societies will benefit from optimised resource use with minimal impact on the environment.

Interactions between humans and machines are on the verge of a radical shift with the potential to unlock immense possibilities facilitated through the concept known as the IoT. With simultaneous advances in technologies such as artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning, these conversations can enable devices to anticipate, react, respond and enhance the physical world.

The IoT is well-poised to usher in the next technological revolution since the time of the Internet. It has been drawing more and more attention as the world turns increasingly digital. There is no doubt about the value the IoT has unlocked so far and its potential to change lives.

As the world gets increasingly connected, the global IoT spending

is set to increase significantly over the coming years. Though there are still nagging security concerns with the IoT—that are yet to be addressed—a study by Cradlepoint (industry leader in cloud-delivered 4G LTE network solutions for businesses, service providers and government organisations) reveals that close to 70 per cent organisations have adopted, or plan to adopt, IoT solutions within the next year. Gartner forecasts 20.8 billion connected devices by 2020. Bain predicts the combined markets of the IoT will grow to about US\$ 520 billion in 2021, more than double the US\$ 235 billion spent in 2017 (Figure 1).

The Indian market scenario

India is rapidly growing as an IoT hub. Although, the country began its IoT

journey much later than developed economies, its installed base of connected units is expected to grow at a rate much faster than them. According to a Deloitte report, the IoT units in India are expected to see a rapid growth of ~32x to reach 1.9 billion units by 2020, from the current base of 60 million. As a result, the Indian IoT market is expected to grow ~7x to move from US\$ 1.3 billion in 2016 to US\$ 9 billion by 2020 (Figure 2). Key technology factors enabling IoT adoption in India include sensors, networks, standards, augmented intelligence and augmented behaviour (Table 1).

Rise of the tech-savvy consumer along with increasing smartphone and mobile Internet penetration is driving consumer IoT applications in the